

Steven Macchia

Trust & Safety and Compliance Leader | AI-Assisted Moderation | Child Safety | Regulatory Compliance

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Trust and Safety (T&S) and Compliance leader with 10+ years in Trust & Safety and online communities. Built a gaming UGC platform's Trust & Safety function from zero and rose through three promotions to lead global compliance and Trust & Safety. Partners with Product, Engineering, Legal, and Operations to turn safety and regulatory requirements into working systems. Experienced in AI-assisted moderation with human review, child safety and CSAM response, law enforcement response, privacy and regulatory compliance (GDPR, CCPA, DSA), and building LLM-powered safety tools.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- **Built the Trust & Safety function from zero** at a gaming UGC platform: Community Standards, enforcement playbooks, escalations, and the team.
- **Led global privacy and regulatory compliance** across GDPR, CCPA, and the DSA, including AI and technology vendor governance.
- **Oversaw moderation of billions of items a month** across multiple AI vendors and human review, and managed the vendor budget.
- **Managed 3 team managers, each leading about 30 people**, and distributed policy guidance to a site of 300+ moderators.
- **Established the company's NCMEC partnership**, strengthening child-safety reporting, response, and investigations.
- **\$1M+ projected annual savings** from a zero-to-one, platform-wide user reputation system.
- **Built T&S Workbench**, 10 free Trust & Safety tools including LLM-powered policy, notice, and appeal assistants.

SKILLS

Leadership & Strategy: Function Building (0 to 1), Program Strategy, Managing Managers, Budget and Vendor Management, Cross-Functional Leadership, Stakeholder Management, Team Leadership, Product and Engineering Partnership, Product Requirements, KPIs and Success Metrics, Vendor and Contract Governance, BPO Operations, Industry Partnerships

Trust & Safety: T&S Program Development (0 to 1), Content Moderation at Scale, Content Policy and Community Standards, Enforcement Guidelines, Child and Youth Safety, Child Sexual Abuse Material (CSAM) Response, NCMEC Reporting, Law Enforcement Response, Investigations, Escalation and Incident Response, Appeals, Reputation Scoring, Risk Signal Detection, Platform Integrity

Compliance & Privacy: GDPR, CCPA, Digital Services Act (DSA), Privacy Governance, Data Protection Impact Assessments (DPIA), ROPA, DSAR, Data Processing Agreements (DPA), Data Retention, Sanctions Research, Regulatory Risk Assessment, Vendor Risk Management

AI & Automation: AI-Assisted Moderation, Human-in-the-Loop Review, Automated Detection Evaluation, Moderation Vendor Evaluation, LLM Tooling and Prompt Design, AI Vendor Governance, AI Risk Mitigation

Tools: Hive, OCR, Deepgram, Claude (LLM), SQL (MySQL), Zendesk, GitHub

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Head of Global Compliance and Trust & Safety

Medal.tv | Sep 2024 – Present

- Lead global Trust & Safety and compliance for a gaming UGC platform moderating billions of videos, images, and text submissions each month with AI-assisted scanning (OCR, Hive, audio transcription), reputation scoring, and appeals.
- Direct global privacy and regulatory compliance across GDPR, CCPA, and the EU Digital Services Act (DSA): DPIAs, ROPA, DSARs, data retention, sanctions research, and vendor oversight.
- Translate policy and compliance requirements into product specifications and success metrics with Engineering, Product, Data, Legal, and Operations.
- Manage CSAM escalations, investigations, preservation requests, and law enforcement inquiries with NCMEC, legal counsel, and authorities.

- Evaluate the performance and limitations of automated moderation, balancing AI detection with human review to improve detection accuracy, reviewer efficiency, and user outcomes.
- Manage the Trust & Safety vendor budget and relationships across multiple AI moderation vendors (OCR, image, video, and audio scanning) and Deepgram transcription, including contracts, DPAs, and data-processing reviews.

Safety Manager

Medal.tv | Jan 2024 – Sep 2024

- Led the zero-to-one build of a platform-wide user reputation system, projected to save \$1M+ annually while improving moderation efficiency and enforcement accuracy.
- Led the migration of AI-assisted moderation and scanning for visual and text content across a short-form video platform.
- Defined safety use cases, escalation logic, and success metrics for automated moderation; combined signals across safety systems and user data to surface harmful behavior and moderation gaps.

Program Manager, Trust & Safety

Medal.tv | Jan 2022 – Jan 2024

- Built and scaled foundational Trust & Safety programs for a global gaming UGC platform handling millions of items daily.
- Established Medal's NCMEC partnership and designed escalation and operational workflows for child safety, severe abuse, illegal content, and other high-risk issues.
- Introduced AI-assisted detection with human oversight for nuanced and high-risk cases; evaluated vendors on detection coverage, efficiency, and user safety.
- Built partnerships with Trust & Safety organizations across gaming and technology.

Program Manager, Community Operations

Medal.tv | Apr 2020 – Mar 2022

- Founded Medal's first Community, Social Media, and Trust & Safety functions and built its first T&S team.
- Wrote Medal's Community Standards, enforcement procedures, and operational playbooks from scratch.

Trust & Safety Team Lead

Cognizant | Nov 2017 – Apr 2020

- Managed three team managers, each leading about 30 content moderation and community operations staff; distributed urgent policy guidance to a site of 300+ moderators.
- Built training on sensitive and emerging safety issues; ranked top 3 of 500 employees and was promoted to Supervisor in November 2018.

Community Manager and Technical Support Representative

Survival Servers | Jan 2016 – Jul 2017

- Grew a gaming community and supported thousands of customers via Zendesk; administered MySQL databases.

PROJECTS AND WRITING

Creator, T&S Workbench

stevenmacchia.com | 2026

- Designed and launched 10 free Trust & Safety tools: abuse pre-mortem (58 risks, 104 safeguards, 33 legal obligations), incident tabletop (37 scenarios), metrics framework (36 metrics with SQL), vendor scorecard, maturity model mapped to DTSP and Ofcom codes, and a DSA transparency report builder.
- Built LLM-powered assistants (Claude) for policy stress-testing, enforcement notices, and appeal review, with a person approving every decision; built end to end with AI-assisted development and published across 8 GitHub repositories.

Trust & Safety Writing

LinkedIn | 2026

- Regular analysis on T&S measurement, appeals as a quality signal, child safety, and governing automated enforcement.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Arts (B.A.), Humanitarian Intervention

The New School | New York, NY | 2017